

GROUP DISCUSSION

Group Discussion is a modern method of assessing students' personalities.

It is both a technique and an art and a comprehensive tool to judge the worthiness of the student and his appropriateness for the job.

GD is not an Argument



Difference between Discussion, Debate and GD

Debate – Either Winning or Losing.

Discussion – Expression of your point of view and respecting another's point of view.

A GD, however, calls for a lot more maturity and logic as it is sharing our own ideas and thoughts with the group.

Why do GD's are held?

To prepare you for the future and make you well informed.

To make you listen and talk in a mature and logical manner.

If you need to disagree, then doing so in a graceful manner.

Attacking issues not people.

Carefully listen to other people's points and try to refine your own by using other people's inputs on the subject.

How to Prepare for Group Discussion?

Awareness of Topics Relating to Your Background Is Crucial.

Take the Lead.

There Is No Place for Aggression in Group Discussions.

Communicate Effectively.

Listen Carefully, Do Not Just Hear.

Work On Your Body Language.

Avoid Deviating From the Topic.

Be the First to Summarize the Discussion.

Skills for Effective Participation in GD

The aspects which make up a GD are **verbal communication, non-verbal behavior, conformation to norms, decision-making ability, and cooperation.**

Initiating a Group Discussion

- Introduce yourself.
- Communicate clearly and fluently. While you introduce yourself and the topic, try not to stutter or stammer.
- Present the topic with an interesting take.
- Keep the content relevant.
- Use questions and quotes.
- Use your time efficiently.
- Listen intently.
- Maintain relevance.

TYPES OF GD:

GD can be Topic based or Case based-

Topic based group discussion can be of three types:

Factual topics

Controversial topics

Abstract topics

FACTUAL TOPICS

Factual topics are about practical things, which an ordinary person is aware of in his day to day life

Typically they are socio- economic topics. These can be the current topic.

Such topics gives a candidate a chance to prove that he is aware of and sensitive to his environment.

CONTROVERSIAL TOPICS

They are the ones that are argumentative in nature. They are meant to generate controversy.

In GDs where such topics are given for discussion the noise and temper is usually high.

The idea behind giving such topic is likely to see how much maturity the candidate is displaying by keeping his temper in check.

ABSTRACT TOPICS

Abstract topics are about intangible things.

These topics are used to check your lateral thinking and creativity.

Eg: the number 10

Joy

Color red

CASE BASED GD

Another variation is the use of case instead of a topic.

The case study tries to simulate a real life situation . Information about the situation will be given to you and you would be asked as a group to resolve the situation.

In case study there are no incorrect answers or perfect solutions.

The objective is to get you think about the situation from various angles.

What does GD check?

Communication Skills

Knowledge

Reasoning ability

Leadership Skills

Flexibility

Convincing power

Ability to work in team

Creativity

Group Dynamics

Level of maturity

Interpersonal skills

Initiative attitude

Preparation for GD?

GD reflects the inherent qualities of an individual .

Reading: This is the first and the most crucial step in preparation.

Mocks: Create an informal GD group and meet regularly to discuss and exchange feedback.

Personalities Reflected in a GD

Passive

- Submissive
- Hesitates to Take Initiative

Assertive

- Open to Accept Ideas
- Initiates and Encourages others

Aggressive

- Dominating
- Argumentative

DO'S IN GROUP DISCUSSION

- Appropriate to the issue.
- Talk with confidence and self-assurance.
- Listen to the other participants actively & carefully.
- Whatever you say must be with a logical flow, validate it with an example as far as possible.
- Make only accurate statements.
- Modulate the volume, pitch and tone.



DON'TS DURING GROUP DISCUSSION

- Being shy /nervous / keeping isolated from G.D
- Interrupting another participant before his arguments are over
- Speak in favor ; example: Establish your position and stand by it stubbornly
- Changed opinions
- Don't make fun of any participant even if his arguments are funny.



PARAMETERS OF EVALUATION IN GD

Language Proficiency	• Usage of effective words and phrases related to the topic • Usage of Effective sentence structures
Content	• Conceptual Knowledge • General Awareness • Knowledge of Current Affairs
Communication Skills	• Voice Modulation • Body Language • Listening Skills • Persuasion Skills
Team Behavior	• Behavior with other team members • Role played to achieve the goals of team
Logical Thinking & Analytical Skills	• Speaking coherently with the topic • Speaking in coordination with others' points • Touching all possible dimensions of the topic

PHRASES TO USE IN GROUP DISCUSSION

Giving an opinion

- In my opinion
- As far as I'm concerned
- Personally, I believe that
- The way I see it is



Getting further information

- Would you please explain that a little more, please?
- Could you explain that point please?



TIPS FOR PARTICIPATION in GD...

Taking a Position viz-a-viz the Topic...

- ✓ Always take a holistic view of the topic
- ✓ Avoid statements like:
 - “I whole heartedly support the topic”
 - “I completely disagree with the topic”
- ✓ Start as, “there are points in favor of and against the topic.....”

If You have a Soft Voice...

- ✓ Raise voice level but do not shout
-

- ✓ Look for moments when the noise levels are not very high and get into the discussion.

If You are Interrupted while Discussing your Topic...

Tell in clear and unambiguous terms that you should be allowed to speak

You can say:

- ☐ Excuse me, please let me complete
- ☐ Just a minute-let me finish my point
- ☐ Raise your voice slightly

How to Get into the Discussion...

- ✓ Take Initiative
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- ✓ Be attentive and get into discussion comfortably.
 - ✓ Identify strong speakers and soft speakers in the group.

Get into Discussion...

- ✓ By using sentences like
- ✓ “Yes, what you say is true.....”
- ✓ “....but there is something more that we should look at...”
- ✓ “...and there is another reason to support what you say...”

Summarization Techniques

Most GD's do not really have conclusions.

Keep the following points in mind while summarizing a discussion:

Avoid raising new points.

Avoid stating only your viewpoint.

Avoid dwelling only on one aspect of the GD.

Keep it brief and concise.

It must incorporate all the important points that came out during the GD.

If the examiner asks you to summarize a GD, it means the GD has come to an end. Do not add anything once the GD has been summarized.

The Perfect Candidate

Be attentive

Personal appearance

Answering questions completely

Wide knowledge

Positive attitude and behavior

Good communication skills



What is a body language?

Body language is a form of non-verbal communication, which consists of body postures, gestures, facial expressions, and eye movements. Humans send and interpret such signals almost entirely subconsciously.

Human communication consists of 93 percent body language and paralinguistic cues, while only 7% of communication consists of words themselves. An encouraging body language can be a wonderful medium to convey your confidence, enthusiasm, and trustworthiness to the interviewers.



Making a good “First Impression”

The way you dress is the single biggest nonverbal communication you make about yourself.

Your dress conveys success, trustworthiness, intelligence, and suitability.

Lean towards the conservative side of style.

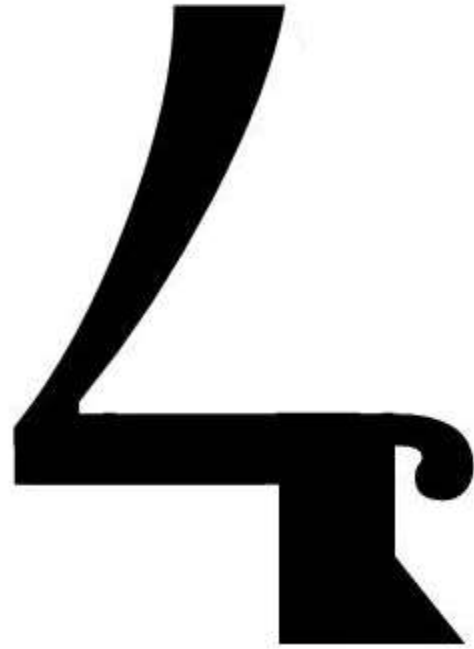
Avoid loud colors and printed fabrics

Make sure your clothes are nicely pressed.

Bring an extra tie, shirt or scarf

Body

Remember the DIGIT



Real World Examples

Defensive



Arrogance



Annoyed



Irritated



Happy



Confused

Worried



twenty19

Importance of body Language...

1. Body language alone can make or break the impression you leave on others.
2. Body language comprises 55% of total communication.
3. Every facet of our personality is evident from our appearance, posture and the way we move.
4. An encouraging body language can be a wonderful medium to convey your confidence, enthusiasm, and trustworthiness to the interviewers.
5. In a job interview, it's likely that your body language will have more of a positive impact on your success than anything you say.



Body Language: Group Discussion



Dos	Don'ts
Be Confident	Be Overconfident
Sit Up Straight	Slouch
Keep Eye Contact	Stare
Smile	Frown
Watch Your Hands	Fidget

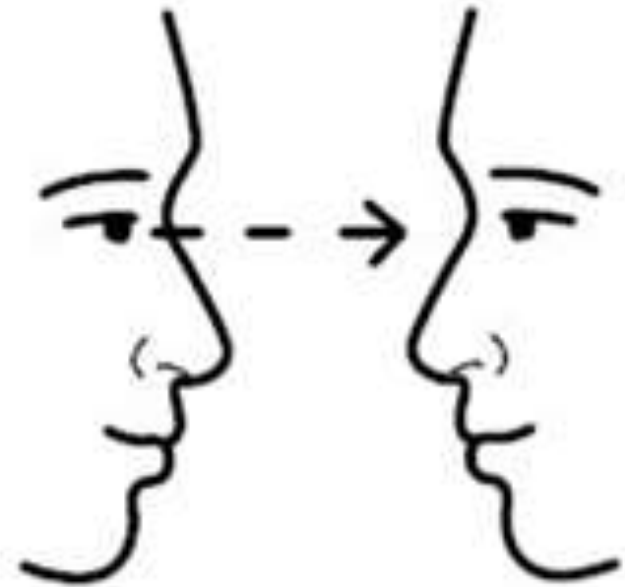


Handshake



Perfect

Eye Contact



Body Language: Group Discussion

Avoid Following Gestures



Eye Rub

Avoiding eye contact to hide or avoid a lie.



Nose Touch

Disguise own deceit or doubt speaker's words.



Ear Rub

Block the speaker's words.



Neck Scratch

Signal of doubt or uncertainty.



Body Language: Group Discussion

Avoid Following Gestures



Collar Pull

Angry, frustrated or sweating.



Fingers in Mouth

Under Pressure.
Inner need for reassurance.



Boredom

Lack of interest and boredom.



Pain in Neck

Avoiding listener's gaze when lying



Body Language: Group Discussion

Avoid Following Gestures



Arm Cross

Defensive or negative attitude.



Partial-Arm Cross

Lack in self-confidence.



Arm + Leg Cross

Person has withdrawn from the conversation.



Both Hands Behind Head

Feeling Confident, Dominant or Superior. Know-it-all.



Body Language: Group Discussion

Use Following Gestures



Neutral Head Position

Neutral attitude about what he is hearing.



Interested Head Position

Indicates that the interest has developed.



Do not cross your legs while sitting in a group discussion.







Be Like this.....



Few GD Topics

E- books or printed books: what's your choice?

Government schools Vs private schools

Demonitization– success or publicity

Hard work or smart work – Which is better

Should politicians have a retirement age?

Should capital punishment be legal? Yes or no